

Meta

Spending roughly twice its 2025 capex on AI infrastructure it consumes itself · ai.meta.com

2004

Founded

\$56.3B

Q1 2026 revenue

+33%

Revenue growth

\$135–145B

2026 capex

3.56B

Daily active people

01 Overview

The only hyperscale AI spender whose infrastructure is almost entirely self-consumed — there is no Azure or AWS equivalent selling capacity to third parties.

Offering: Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp and Reality Labs on the consumer side; the Llama open-weight model family and, from 2026, Meta Superintelligence Labs, whose first proprietary model is Muse Spark.

Key facts

HQ: Menlo Park, California

Ownership: Public (NASDAQ: META)

Revenue: \$56.31B in Q1 2026, up 33% year over year — the fastest growth since 2021 — with income from operations of \$22.87B. Family daily active people reached 3.56 billion

Web: ai.meta.com · [LinkedIn](#)

Key people: Mark Zuckerberg (Founder, Chairman & Chief Executive Officer) · Alexandr Wang (Chief AI Officer; lead of Meta Superintelligence Labs)

Digital twin: No · **GenAI:** Yes (Llama, Muse Spark)

02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

Sector	Deployment	Reported impact	Source
Digital infrastructure	A \$14B El Paso data centre joint venture with BlackRock funds owning 80%, announced the day before Q2 2026 earnings, structured so Meta can de-consolidate capital expenditure...	Part of a programme including \$107B of new contractual commitments announced in Q1 2026 alone	Link
AI infrastructure spend	Capital expenditure directed at AI data centres, GPUs and power, including what Meta describes as the largest AI training cluster in the world — a 2 gigawatt facility	2026 guidance raised three times to \$135–145B against \$72.22B actually spent in 2025;	Link
Frontier models	Meta Superintelligence Labs, launched in 2026 with the acquisition of the Scale AI team led by Alexandr Wang, released Muse Spark in April 2026	Meta AI reached roughly 1.2 billion monthly active users by Q1 2026, up from 1 billion in May 2025;	Link

03 Competitive Landscape

Other vendors in this market: Amazon Web Services · Anthropic · Google · Microsoft · NVIDIA · OpenAI · Perplexity · xAI

Where it sits: Meta's relevance to an infrastructure portfolio is not as a vendor — it sells advertising, and Llama is given away. It matters as a counterparty and a demand driver. The most directly relevant fact in this research pass: in the week before Q2 2026 earnings, Meta and BlackRock announced a \$14B El Paso data centre joint venture with...

04 GIP & BlackRock Connections

GIP became a wholly-owned BlackRock subsidiary in October 2024 and now operates as BlackRock's dedicated infrastructure-investment arm. Stakes below are standard institutional/index-fund positions unless otherwise noted.

Entity	Possible connection
Global Infrastructure Partners	No publicly disclosed direct GIP relationship. However, the \$14B El Paso data centre joint venture with BlackRock funds at 80% ownership is the closest adjacency of any vendor in this app
BlackRock	Direct and material: a \$14B El Paso data centre joint venture announced in 2026, with BlackRock funds owning 80%.

05 Sentiment

Customer: Meta has no enterprise customer base in the sense the other vendors here do — its customers are advertisers and its models are given away. The relevant sentiment is investor sentiment, and it is sceptical: shares fell about 7% after Q1 2026 despite beating...

What supports the story

- Q1 2026 revenue up 33% to \$56.31B, the fastest growth since 2021, with ad impressions up 19% and pricing up 12%
- 3.56 billion daily active people across the app family — a distribution base no AI competitor can match
- The BlackRock El Paso joint venture shows a workable route to funding capacity without carrying all of it on balance sheet

What to pressure-test

- Almost all capex is self-consumed — unlike Microsoft and Amazon, Meta has no third-party cloud revenue to offset the buildout
- Capex guidance raised three times to \$135–145B, roughly double 2025, while GPU-heavy assets depreciate over a 4–6 year life
- Meta extended its depreciation assumption to 5.5 years in 2025, worth nearly \$2.9B of reported profit — an accounting tailwind, not an operating one

Employee: Meta is cutting about 8,000 roles effective 20 May 2026 — roughly 10% of the workforce — and leaving a further 6,000 open positions unfilled, the largest restructuring since the 2022–23...

Sources: Meta public filings/website, company fact sheets, Wikipedia, PitchBook/Crunchbase/Datanyze/BuiltIn profiles, Glassdoor employer reviews, vendor case studies and press releases as of Sept. 2026. Figures marked "est." or "not disclosed" are third-party estimates or unavailable — not company-confirmed — validate in diligence. Part of the Physical AI / Industrial AI for Critical Infrastructure market landscape.